

Communication & connectivity

We sat down with Huawei's Anand Narang, Marketing and Solutions Director for India. The company's taking some aggressive strides in the smartphone segment, and also has offerings in the data communication and cloud computing segment

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Q Would it be fair to say that Huawei offers value for money products and aims at the entry-level consumer in the market?

Huawei believes in technology leadership and innovations. Our focus has been on a portfolio of products – smart phones, data cards & tablets. In each of these product categories, we are offering a suite of latest technology, e.g., cloud+ features (phone finder, 16GB memory, message+ to send images, music, files etc.), the world's first multi-mode 4G dongle, the world's fastest data cards and slimmest data cards and also the world's thinnest and fastest smart phones etc. Our focus is on delivering premium experiences to mass market, driven by our local consumer insights.

Q How do Huawei's cloud services differ from other offerings in the market?

When you sign up for Cloud+, you automatically get 16 GB of free storage. Since your contacts, mails, messages, camera rolls, settings and account information doesn't use as much space, you will find that 16 GB of storage goes a long way. You can store up to 3500 songs or 7000 photos. If your Huawei phone is missing, Hicloud can help you figure out where your phone is. Log on to www.hicloud.com; use the Phone finder feature to locate your phone on

the Google maps. Not just locate, perform other security functions to safeguard your data from intruders.

Q Do people really buy Internet dongles all that much in India?

Huawei command 70 per cent market share in operator forward bundled data card. We sell over 3 million data cards every year. While continuing to support and work closely with operators for the 80 per cent forward bundled data cards, Huawei will also bring offerings to the remaining 20 percent consumers who need an unlocked data card who are free to choose operator & plan. Huawei will work closely with operators to offer reversed bundled data plans in the open market helping operators expand their data business.

Q Your thoughts on 4G rollout in the country and when will you offer 4G dongles?

Many of the leading operators have already declared the launch of their next generation networks, which will be based on LTE. With the launch of Bharti Airtel's 4G services, Huawei, the telecom solution provider, gets the opportunity to offer its first LTE Router B593 and LTE USB Stick E392 to the Indian customers. The company globally leads the mobile broadband and data cards segment with over 55% of market share. The entry of LTE in the technology world will definitely prove



Anand Narang, Marketing and Solutions Director, Huawei India

to be the right choice for a new era in mobile communication.

Q Are you guys working on creating brand awareness? What are the challenges?

Consumers in India would not have seen much yet in the name of marketing activity from Huawei. But in terms of reaching out through digital media and retail outlets, we are still active. At present we are increasing our channel strength. At present we are still in the process of understanding Indian customers. Once we do that, only then would it be right for us to invest money in ad-campaigns so that we have the right products distributed using the right vehicles to accompany the television commercials and print ad campaigns. Huawei wants to understand the Indian consumer's preferences for 3G and 4G devices across smartphone / tablet / data cards. So that's a challenge. We are also engaging consumers around connected experiences with our 360 touch point strategy. We are also leveraging new channels like Facebook to provide online service to our consumers.

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